



Thunderbolt

Imagine this scenario: Transferring a full HD movie in under 30 secs. You may think that we are talking of the future. Just a minor adjustment - that future is here. Formerly known as Light Peak, the Thunderbolt is an interface to connect peripheral devices to the computer by the extension bus. Intel developed the technology and it was commercially available in the Apple MacBook Pro this year. The Thunderbolt cable can carry data, video, audio and power in a single connection. Each Thunderbolt port on the MacBook Pro also provides about 10 W of power to connected peripherals. In fact the MacBook Pro's only feature one



mini display port which is also used as a Thunderbolt port. It takes data transfer speeds to dizzying heights. With a theoretical speed of 10Gbps, it is blazing fast. Add the fact that it is bi-directional in nature, that means it can receive and send data simultaneously at this speed. That effectively means that it is faster than USB 3.0, eSATA, FireWire. Bottlenecking with present generation devices is a given as SATA 3 port max out at 6 Gbps. Intel initially had used an optical interface for data transfers, but later on switched to copper wires as it reduces production costs and most vendors still use electrical connections. The optical fiber cables are under development, but they will not carry power for now and Intel plans to use them only for lengths longer than 3 metres.

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Pimp My Case

Case modding is a whole culture in itself wherein hardware enthusiasts make quirky aesthetic design changes to their chassis. At the most simplest level you can cut out the

like a computer chassis at all. Some types of mods include: Windows mod - no this has got nothing to do with the operating system of the same name, but involves doing something with the side panels (most likely, the left hand one); Lighting mods involve going wild with lighting around



80.3 per cent

is Intel's market share for the third quarter in 2011. Although this is slightly lower than its last years' share of 80.6 per cent, the overall shipments of processors had increased by 5 per cent this year. Eighty per cent is a huge number and just goes on to show the hold Intel has over the processor market.



Gordon Moore

Anyone remotely interested in computing will at some point of time have heard of the famous Moore's Law which goes on to state that, "the number of transistors that can be placed inexpensively on an integrated circuit doubles approximately every two years." This was stated by Gordon Moore, co-founder of Intel, way back in 1965. Gordon Moore co-founded Intel

in 1968 and was named its Chairman emeritus in 1975. Just when Moore's law was being threatened thanks to difficulties in packing in more transistors in less space (at the same time keeping the leakage current, power consumption and heat issues at bay), Intel announced the Ivy Bridge platform earlier this year. The Ivy Bridge processor will use a tri-gate transistor which makes use of a 3D fin in the silicon chip for improved switching.



Zettabyte

One Zettabyte = 10^{21} bytes whereas One

Terabyte = 10^{12} bytes. We are already consuming exabytes of information. In fact a study done by Messrs George Gilder and Bret Swanson from the Discover Centre predicts that by 2015, US internet traffic would be counted in Zettabytes. This data will comprise of movie downloads, VoIP apps, online gaming, and cloud computing. Read more here: <http://goo.gl/Sql5p>



side panel and add an acrylic sheet making the innards visible. Of course, you will have to invest in LED lights to make the interiors visible. Some case modders are so adept at this art, that one glance at the modded case will not look or within your case. Cooling mods which have a more functional aspect than just plain aesthetics, most commonly indulged in by enthusiasts who will stretch their processor prowess to its limit.

How long till we have a 1 Zettabyte drive, we would hazard a guess of a decade atleast;